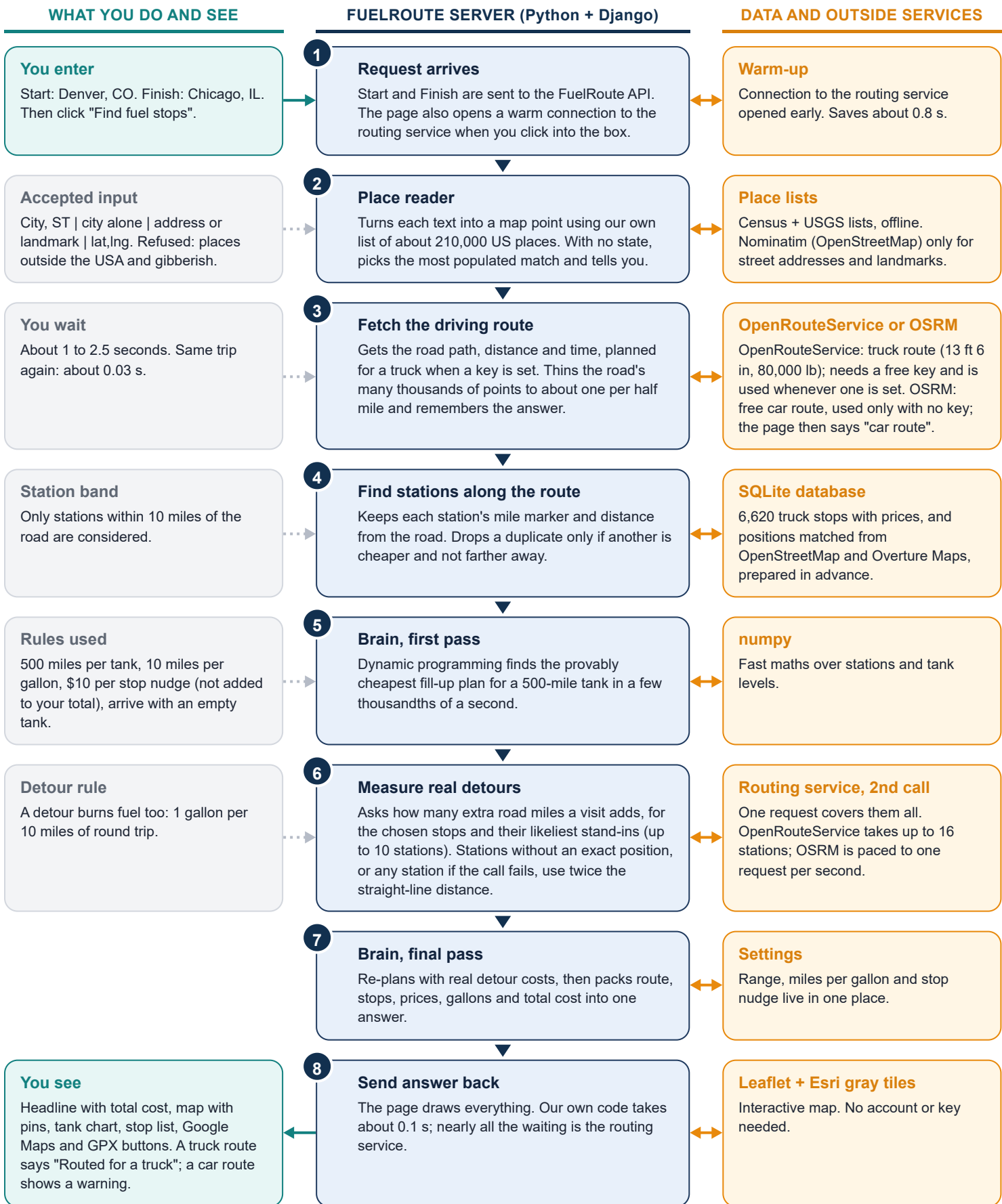


FuelRoute: how a trip plan is made

Follow the numbers 1 to 8: what you do, what the server does, and which data or outside service it asks.



HOW TO READ THIS

→ data moves on ↔ server asks, service answers ... rule or note for that step
Pin colours: ● cheapest ● middle ● dearest

Real example: Denver to Chicago is about 1,000 miles, 2 fuel stops, about \$295.53 of fuel on a truck route.

How to use FuelRoute

Fields to enter

Field	What to type	Example
Start	Where the trip begins. Required.	Seattle, WA
Finish	Where the trip ends. Required.	Miami, FL
Other styles	City alone (the most populous matching US place is chosen), a landmark or street address, or raw coordinates.	Chicago Mount Rushmore 39.74,-104.99
Not accepted	Places outside the USA, or text that is not a real place.	Paris, France xyz

Step by step: what to do

1	Open the FuelRoute page. You will see two boxes, Start and Finish, a swap button, and a button labelled "Find fuel stops".
2	Type your Start place. City and state works best, for example Denver, CO. Clicking into the box lets the page warm up the connection, so the first search is faster.
3	Type your Finish place. Same styles as Start. If you entered them the wrong way round, press the swap button.
4	Click "Find fuel stops". Wait about 1 to 3 seconds. Behind the scenes the server runs steps 2 to 7 from the diagram.
5	Check which places were used. If you typed a name shared by several places (such as Chicago or Miami), the page tells you which one it chose and shows the others as links. Tap a link to switch.
6	Read the headline. It states the answer in a sentence, for example "Seattle, WA to Miami, FL needs \$1,041.62 of fuel" (the exact figure depends on the route and the price file). That is the total fuel cost and does not include the pretend \$10 per stop.
7	Look at the map. The route is drawn as a line. A and B mark start and finish. Numbered pins are fuel stops: green is the cheapest price, yellow is middle, pink is the dearest.
8	Look at the tank-level chart. The line falls as you drive and jumps up where you fill. It shows how much fuel is in the tank along the trip.
9	Go through the stop list. Each stop shows its price and how many gallons to buy. Hover over a stop and its pin and chart point light up.
10	Take the plan with you. Use the Google Maps button (phones accept only 3 stops per link, so long trips come as numbered parts to do in order), or download the GPX file and load it in a truck GPS. Google Maps plans its own car route between the stops, so for a truck use a truck GPS for the actual driving.
11	Check the stop names before you drive. Open the popup of any stop marked approximate or uncertain and confirm the station name when you arrive.

Good to know

What the pin popups can say Position approximate: only the city centre is known, so the real station may be miles away. Pin is at the highway exit: the exit is exact, the station is somewhere near it. Two map sources disagree on which station this is: our best guess is shown, so check the name when you arrive.	Assumptions behind the numbers 500 miles per full tank, 10 miles per gallon, you arrive with an empty tank (no reserve). Fuel prices are a snapshot from one spreadsheet. Traffic is ignored. Continental US only. Routes are planned for a truck (13 ft 6 in, 80,000 lb) when an OpenRouteService key is set. With no key the page shows a car route and says so. Truck limits come from map data, which is patchy: watch the signs.
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FuelRoute plans where to fill up and how much to buy. It is not a turn-by-turn navigator, so drive with Google Maps or a GPS loaded from the page buttons.